

Element A

Element A: Presentation and Justification of the Problem

Problem Statement and Details (A1, A2, A5)

The mic flags at Walpole High currently have many issues. The largest issue with the mic flags are that the sides of the flags are falling off and peeling. This prevents the flag from communicating with the Timber TV and Ambush News brands as the logo either is not on the side of the flag anymore, or the logos become obstructed due to the peeling messing with the logo. The other issue with the current flags is that they are not staying in place on certain mic holders. Since the flags are not stable while being used, the flag has trouble communicating the brand as they move during the short, preventing the camera from getting a clear view of the flag which is needed to advertise the brand. To fix the mic flag problem, we are going to design a durable, lightweight, replaceable, secure mic flag that communicates and promotes the TimberTV and Ambush News' logo and allows broadcasters to have multiple flag options to choose from when recording with quantifiable constraints such as weighing under 100 grams and having a panel for the logo that is at least 75mm by 50mm.

Pictures of the Problem



Figure 1&2. Side of Mic Flags Falling Off (Jack S).

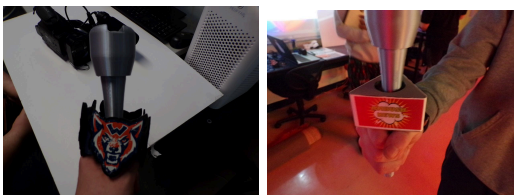


Figure 3&4. Mic Flags Falling Off Holder (Paul D.)

Stakeholder Concerns and Connections (A3, A4)

Our primary stakeholder is Mr O'Farrell. Mr O'Farrell is the head of Walpole High School's TV Studio and he will use the flags for years to come with many students. The students in TV Production are also stakeholders as they are involved with making videos/films while interviewing other people. These students will use the mic flags to promote TimberTV and

Ambush News while they are making the videos/films. A third stakeholder is Mr Connolly. Mr Connolly is an advisor for the Walpole High School film. He will need these flags on the nights of the film festival so that the students interviewing the filmmakers can appear in a professional fashion. The final stakeholder is the students and teachers who will be interviewed by Ambush News and Timber TV. The people being interviewed will want to feel like they are being interviewed by a professional news company and the mic flags go a long way to making that feeling a reality as professional news companies often use mic flags on their microphones.

Problem Importance (A6)

We need to make mic flags as they are pivotal for a production company to be able to advertise their brand. As stated by Schulze-Brakel, the world's leading manufacturer of sound improvement solutions, "the microphone flag doesn't actually fill a need. It's fundamental and just intention is to advance the news office's logo on it during interviews. It will typically convey the logo and name so individuals watching the meeting on TV can realize who is doing the meeting" (Schulze-Brakel). When we were in our initial interview with Mr. O'Farrell, he mentioned that in his previous position as a broadcaster for Boston Fox 25 News he used these flags (Mr. O'Farrell). During an event, where other stations were on the scene, broadcasters would determine whether these flags were used during the segment or not.

Walpole High School's Production company is in desperate need for new mic flags as the ones last year did not stand the test of time. The logos on the mic flags have started to peel and fade, while the adhesive holding the panels on other flags does not keep the panels on the flag anymore. According to Mr O'Farrell, the current flags cannot be used as they are incapable of communicating and promoting the TimberTV and Ambush News brand and logo. The peeling and fading is causing the logos to become unrecognizable while the lack of a working adhesive is preventing the logos from staying on the flag during an interview.

Work Cited

Jack S, "TV Studio Mic Flag Pics" January 2024

O'Farrell, Peter. Personal Interview. 11 January 2024.

Paul D. "More TV Studio Mic Flag Pics" January 2024

Schulze.brakel. "What is the purpose of microphone flags? | by Schulzebrakelofficial."
Medium, 15 June 2022,

<https://medium.com/@schulze.brakel01/what-is-the-purpose-of-microphone-flags-7bce7093eb7c>. Accessed 30 January 2024.

